

FOR DESIGNERS REVIEWING AI-GENERATED INTERFACES

Accessibility Checklist for AI-Generated Designs

We audited **123 AI-generated designs** and 74% failed at least one accessibility check. These 10 items are what a design review now has to cover, ordered by how often each one breaks.

7 ACCESSIBILITY BASICS, CHECK IN THIS ORDER, BY FAILURE RATE

- ☐ **1 Skip navigation link** 95%

A link that lets keyboard users jump past repeated nav. Tab into the page: does "skip to main content" appear?
- ☐ **2 Labeled main content area** 53%

The primary region must use `<main>` or `role="main"`. Ask: does a landmark wrap the content?
- ☐ **3 Labels on every form field** 49%

Every input needs a programmatically associated label. Placeholder text does not count: it disappears on typing.
- ☐ **4 One h1, headings step down** 42%

One page title (h1), then h2s for sections, h3s for subsections. No skipped levels (h1 to h3). Use HeadingsMap or the browser inspector to verify.
- ☐ **5 Real buttons, not styled links** 36%

Actions use `<button>`, navigation uses `<a>`. A `div onClick` is neither. Test: can you activate every action with Enter and Space?
- ☐ **6 No skipped heading levels** 29%

AI often drops components with their own h2 inside a section already using h2. Run a second heading pass after components are added.



7 Names on icon-only buttons

19%

A button with only an icon needs `aria-label` or a visually-hidden label. Ask: what does a screen reader announce when focused?

3 MORE, ALWAYS INCLUDE THESE



A Motion respects prefers-reduced-motion

33%

1 in 3 AI-generated screens miss this. Make it a standing review question alongside loading states.



B Copy rewritten by hand

95%

Generic CTAs ("click here") appeared in 95% of projects. AI defaults to vague language. Specific, action-first copy is fast to fix and still requires a human.



C Two separate sign-offs

"Looks right" and "is accessible" are different approvals. A missing label or a fake button is a defect, the same as a broken checkout flow.

EU compliance. The European Accessibility Act has applied to any product sold into the EU since June 28, 2025, regardless of where your company is based. These gaps are legal exposure, not craft debt. Use that framing to get buy-in. **WebAIM's 2026 scan** found 95.9% of the top million web pages had at least one detectable failure. AI inherited a pre-existing problem. Build the check in now.